



AI OPERATIONAL READINESS & GOVERNANCE TOOLKIT

Orientation & Methodology Map



by Chloe Devine

AI STRATEGY • GOVERNANCE • OPERATIONAL READINESS

Methodology Overview

Understanding how the assets work together

Purpose

The AI Operational Readiness & Governance Toolkit provides a structured approach for helping organizations move from AI experimentation to accountable operations. Each asset supports a different part of understanding the work, evaluating opportunities, designing AI-enabled workflows, establishing governance and evidence requirements, preparing for implementation, and sustaining accountability in operation.

Core Flow

Discover → Prioritize → Classify → Design → Govern → Evidence → Prepare → Operate

What This Methodology Helps Define

Toolkit Asset	Question It Answers
AI Opportunity Discovery Workbook	What is happening today, and where are the opportunities, constraints, and risks?
Opportunity Prioritization Matrix	Which opportunities deserve further attention?
AI Use Case Categories	What AI capability pattern does the work require?
Current-State → Future-State Framework	How should the work change?
Decision Rights Framework	Who reviews, approves, escalates, intervenes, and remains accountable?
Evidence Framework	What must be observed, retained, and verified?
Pilot Readiness Framework	Is the operating model ready to test and learn?
AI Opportunity Executive Briefing	What does leadership need to understand to decide?

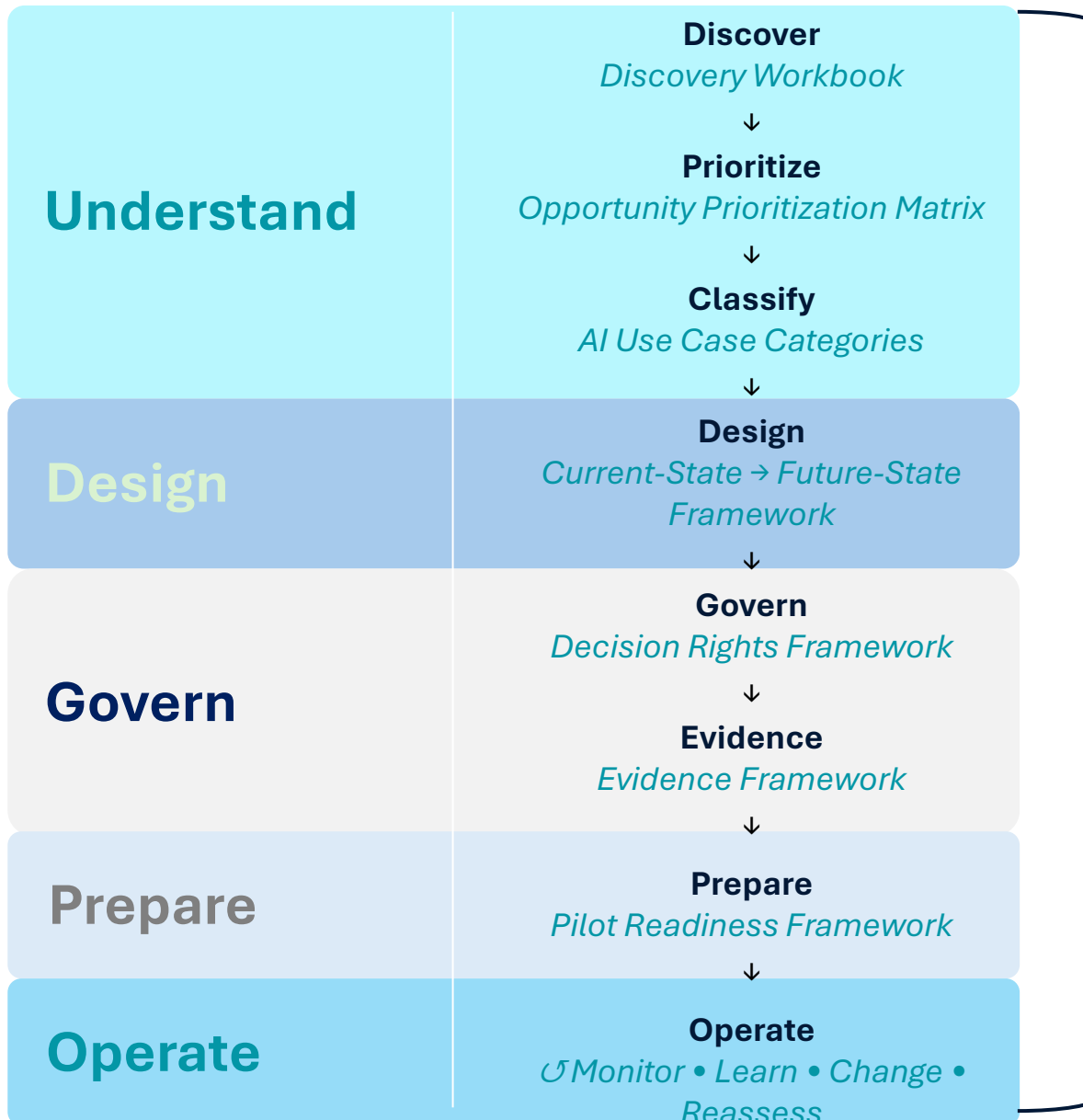
Guiding Philosophy

AI Operational Readiness & Governance is a connected methodology for moving from uncertainty to accountable operations. The assets support the lifecycle; they are not intended to operate as isolated checklists.



Methodology Map

Understanding the sequence of the assets



Executive Briefing:

Lifecycle → Evidence and decisions → Executive Briefing

Guiding Philosophy:

AI Operational Readiness & Governance is a connected methodology, not a collection of independent frameworks.

The lifecycle is connected, not strictly linear. New evidence, changing conditions, or material changes may return the organization to an earlier stage.



How the Toolkit Assets Work

Understand the Work	Design the Operating Model	Establish Accountability	Prepare to Learn	Synthesize the Decision
• Discover Workbook • Opportunity Prioritization Matrix • AI Use Case Categories	• Current-State → Future State Framework	• Decision Rights Framework • Evidence Framework	• Pilot Readiness Framework	• AI Opportunity Executive Briefing

Guiding Philosophy

The assets build on one another, but practitioners may return to earlier assets as evidence, risk, operating conditions, or design assumptions change.



Asset Map

Stage	Asset	Primary Output
Discover	Discovery Workbook	Operational themes, opportunities, constraints, risk, signals
Prioritize	Opportunity Prioritization Matrix	Prioritized opportunities and implementation considerations
Classify	AI Use Case Categories	Primary/supporting AI capability patterns and action implications
Design	Current-State → Future-State Framework	Proposed AI-enabled operating model
Govern	Decision Rights Framework	Review, approval, escalation, intervention, accountability and authority model
Evidence	Evidence Framework	Evidence requirements, signals, provenance, and monitoring approach
Prepare	Pilot Readiness Framework	Pilot boundaries, learning plan, readiness conditions and exit criteria
Synthesize	AI Opportunity Executive Briefing	Executive recommendation and decisions required



From Discovery to Accountable Operations



Guiding Philosophy:

The methodology's purpose is not to produce documentation. It supports better decisions and preserves accountability as operating conditions change.



Key Principles

Understanding the philosophy behind the methodology

- **Start with work, not tools.**
- **Policy is not the operating model.**
- **Access does not equal authority.**
- **Human involvement does not equal human accountability.**
- **Controls should be executable, not merely documented.**
- **Governance decisions should rely on sufficient, trustworthy evidence.**
- **Pilot the operating model, not just the technology.**
- **Changing conditions can change the validity of prior decisions.**
- **Accountability must persist after launch.**



About this Orientation & Methodology Map

Companion Resource

This Orientation & Methodology Map is designed to be used with the *AI Operational Readiness & Governance Practitioner Guide* and *AI Operational Readiness and Governance Toolkit*.

For the complete methodology, principles, and lifecycle content, access the Practitioner Guide here:

[Access the AI Operational Readiness & Governance Practitioner Guide on Zenodo](#)

Access the Toolkit here:

[AI Operational Readiness & Governance Toolkit | Zenodo](#)

Use & Attribution

© 2026 Chloe C. Devine. All rights reserved. You may use this resource in its original form for practitioner reference and application. When referenced, reproduced, presented, or incorporated into other work, attribution to Chloe C. Devine and the *AI Operational Readiness and Governance Practitioner Guide* is required.

You may not alter or republish the underlying framework, instructional content, attribution, or methodology as a modified work without permission.

AI Assistance Disclosure

AI tools supported research synthesis, content organization, editing, and design assistance in developing this resource. The framework, methodology, practitioner guidance, and final editorial decisions were developed and reviewed by Chloe C. Devine.

Practitioner Notice

This resource provides practical guidance and is not a substitute for legal, regulatory, security, compliance, or other professional advice. Organizations should adapt its application to their specific context, risks, policies, and obligations.

AI Operational Readiness & Governance Toolkit: Orientation & Methodology Map | Version 2.0 | September 2026

DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.22983272

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22983272>

